superiority' of his race, which, in the mind of the coloniser, distinguished him from the colonised. This belief, which was the premise of the colonial power structure and a figment of the coloniser's self-important worldview, was legitimised as being 'objective', or 'scientific', or 'rational' and therefore, 'natural'. This evidences the use of scientism by the coloniser to perpetuate, normalise and legitimise stereotypes about the colonised in order to justify discrimination. In fact, the 'scientific' racial consciousness of the coloniser led to race-based stratification of colonised populations across the world, and created specific forms of discrimination which remained in those societies long after decolonisation.

As part of the larger aim of stratification of the colonised society, the coloniser subtly co-opted dominant groups or the elite from the colonised society into the colonial power structure to gradually wean them away from the rest of their people. This was done by inventing pseudo-scientific racial theories to create fissures in the social structures of the native society, while simultaneously teaching them the ways of European culture. Quijano's seminal contribution was his acute observation that the dominant elites of colonised native societies were acculturated not just into the colonial power structure but also the European worldview through the introduction of the cultural complex, namely 'European modernity/rationality', that is, imputing Europeanness to anything that is new or novel, or contemporary, or relevant and rational. Modernity and rationality, as introduced and employed by the European coloniser, therefore, represented (and still represent) the weaponisation of time and appropriation of the very idea of 'reason' by the European coloniser and his successor, the Western imperialist, who negate and deny the histories and the lived experiences of entire civilisations from the moment of their arrival.[8] This gave birth to the process of cultural colonisation and the phenomenon or state of mind known as 'cultural coloniality'. In a nutshell, coloniality refers to a meta phenomenon that affects the mental constitution of the colonised society and reorients its entire worldview to bring it in line with the coloniser's by distorting, stereotyping, eliminating or acculturating the indigenous worldview.

The effect of the introduction of the modernity/rationality complex into the culture of colonised societies was that the entirety of native worldviews, especially their ontological, theological and epistemological systems, were 'otherised'. That is, the indigenous worldview became the 'other' to the